LESSONS LEARNED REGISTER

Project Title:	Mary's Consulting – New Company Website	**Date Prepared:**	Updated continuously; snapshot Dec 1, 2026

Lessons captured throughout project execution and reviewed at each phase gate. To be transferred to the firm's organizational lessons-learned repository at project closeout. Each lesson includes the trigger (what prompted the learning), the lesson itself (actionable takeaway), and the responsible party for applying it on future projects.

ID	Category	Date	Trigger / Situation	Lesson Learned	Responsible Party	Comments
LL-001	Initiation	May 8, 2026	Sponsor (Mary) signed the charter same-day after a single 30-minute review.	**Brief executive sponsors with a one-page summary before the formal review.** The executive summary sent 2 days early made Mary's review purely confirmatory — she had already mentally processed the content. Recommend this as standard practice for any sponsor-approval meeting.	Andrew (PM)	Pattern reused for design and UAT approvals — same speed result.
LL-002	Stakeholder	Jun 18, 2026	Sales Lead initially scored Neutral on the stakeholder register; after early CRM-flow involvement, moved to Supportive.	**Engage downstream consumers (Sales) of project outputs before they become demanders.** Inviting Sales Lead to define lead-quality criteria turned a Neutral stakeholder into a Supportive one and prevented post-launch scope fights.	Andrew (PM)	Replicate for any project where Marketing delivers to Sales.
LL-003	Requirements	Jul 2, 2026	Consultant focus group revealed 3 Must-priority requirements not surfaced in interviews.	**Combine interviews with focus groups for user-research breadth.** Interviews captured individual preferences; focus groups surfaced items that only emerged when consultants discussed with each other (e.g., bio consistency).	Andrew (PM)	Worth the extra week of elapsed time.
LL-004	Design	Aug 7, 2026	Sponsor's design feedback came back faster than planned (2 days vs. 5).	**Have the designer present design reviews in person to the sponsor.** Bill walked Mary through the brand decisions live; questions and approvals happened in the same meeting. Email-only design reviews would have stretched this to a week of back-and-forth.	Bill (UX)	Critical-path activity; saved 3 days.
LL-005	Quality	Aug 26, 2026	Pre-audit found only 4 Sev-3 contrast issues (prior projects averaged 20+).	**Build accessibility linting into CI from day one — don't defer to a final audit.** Catching issues at PR time costs ~5 minutes per fix; catching at audit time costs ~2 hours per fix plus rework risk. ROI was extraordinary.	Bob (Dev) / Bill (UX)	Make this firm-standard for all web projects.
LL-006	Risk	Sep 8, 2026	CRM API gap (no 'industry vertical' field) discovered during integration build.	**Schedule vendor technical-discovery calls BEFORE finalizing build estimates.** A 1-hour vendor call in week 1 of build would have revealed the field gap and let us plan the workaround upfront. Instead we discovered it mid-build and lost 5 days.	Bob (Dev)	Add to firm's procurement-strategy template.
LL-007	Stakeholder	Sep 14, 2026	Consultant bio submission rate stuck at 38% vs. 60% target by week 2.	**Distributed-stakeholder commitments need a named executive sponsor and tiered execution.** The first firm-wide email got a soft response. Mary's personally signed second nudge plus a tiered launch plan (top 50 at launch, remainder later) recovered the situation. Plan for this from day one in similar projects.	Christine	Tiered launch should be the default approach.

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LL-008	Communication	Sep 14, 2026	Editorial review queue bottlenecked on Christine; Marketing Lead absorbed marketing-tone copy review.	**Identify single-point review bottlenecks early and partition the queue.** Splitting review work between Christine (case studies + bios) and Marketing Lead (marketing-tone copy) doubled throughput overnight. Should have done this at content-strategy phase, not week 19.	Christine / Marketing Lead	Add to content-strategy template.
LL-009	Procurement	Sep 16, 2026	Frontend contractor (WebCraft Studios) delivered all milestones on or before due dates.	**Pre-paying 25% to lock contractor schedule is worth it for short engagements.** Made WebCraft prioritize our work; protected the build-phase critical path. Cost ~$625 of working capital tied up for 90 days; payoff was much greater.	Andrew (PM)	Negotiate this term in vendor SOWs by default.
LL-010	Risk	Sep 16, 2026	Sponsor-approval-delay risk (R-04) was originally rated Critical but never materialized.	**Pre-booking sponsor calendar slots and pre-briefing turns the highest sponsor-related risk into a non-event.** This pattern (LL-001, LL-004, LL-010 all relate) should be elevated to a firm-standard risk mitigation.	Andrew (PM)	Cross-references LL-001 and LL-004.
LL-011	Build	Sep 30, 2026	Performance budget enforced in CI prevented two regressions before they reached the performance test in A030.	**Performance budgets in CI are as valuable as automated tests.** They prevent slow code from being merged in the first place — much cheaper than diagnosing and fixing performance regressions later.	Bob (Dev)	Add to firm's CI/CD reference architecture.
LL-012	Planning	Oct 9, 2026	Three-point estimates on build activities (A024, A025, A032) all came in within ±5% of expected duration.	**Three-point estimating works when the team has prior experience with the activity type.** Bob's PERT estimates for build activities were highly accurate; Christine's estimates for bio collection (a novel activity for the firm) had much wider variance. Use 3-point only where the team has informed pessimism.	Andrew (PM)	For novel activities, use higher-uncertainty techniques (e.g., wide ranges, rolling-wave).
LL-013	Test	Nov 17, 2026	UAT completed in 5 days vs. 7 planned, with zero Sev-1/2 findings.	**UAT goes faster when sponsors and SMEs are given written test scenarios in advance.** We sent Mary and the Marketing Lead a 1-page script of 'try these flows' the day before. Their feedback was focused and specific rather than wandering exploration. Consider scripted + exploratory mix.	Andrew (PM)	Saved 2 days on critical path.
LL-014	Launch	Nov 24, 2026	Production cutover happened on a Tuesday with zero incidents.	**Schedule production cutovers Tuesday–Thursday for full vendor-support availability.** Tuesday cutover meant the hosting vendor had full staffing on standby and we had 3 business days of hypercare attention before the weekend. Friday cutovers (often pressured by 'hit the month-end target') frequently fail for exactly the opposite reasons.	Bob (Dev)	Make this a firm-standard cutover policy.

Total lessons captured: 14 across all phases. **Recurring patterns:** sponsor pre-briefing (LL-001, LL-004, LL-010); single-point bottlenecks (LL-008); engaging downstream stakeholders early (LL-002, LL-003). These patterns will be elevated to firm-standard practices at closeout.